

such delightful instances you can truly buy a great deal of something for nothing. I've done it myself numerous times.

You can develop your own stock detection system outside the normal channels of Wall Street, where you'll always get the news late.

Thousands of employees of Storer Communications and its affiliates, plus countless others who work in cable TV or network TV, could have figured out that Storer's TV and cable properties were valued at \$100 per share, while the stock was selling for \$30. Executives knew this, programmers could have known it, cameramen could have known it, and even the people who come around to hook up the cable to the house could have known it. All any of them had to do was buy Storer at \$30 or \$35 or \$40 or \$50 and wait for the Wall Street experts to figure it out. Sure enough, Storer was taken private in late 1985 at \$93.50 a share—which by 1988 turned out to have been a bargain price.

I could go on for the rest of the book about the edge that being in a business gives the average stockpicker. On top of that, there's the consumer's edge that's helpful in picking out the winners from the newer and smaller fast-growing companies, especially in the retail trades. Whichever edge applies, the exciting part is that you can develop your own stock detection system outside the normal channels of Wall Street, where you'll always get the news late.

MY WONDERFUL EDGE

Who could have had a greater advantage than yours truly, sitting in an office at Fidelity during the boom in financial services and in the mutual funds? This was my chance to